

Republic Act 1425 (Rizal Law) & Nationalism

1. Republic Act 1425 (Rizal Law)

📌 Definition

- **Republic Act 1425 (Rizal Law):** A law passed on **June 12, 1956** requiring the inclusion of courses on the life, works, and writings of **Jose Rizal**, particularly *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*, in all public and private schools, colleges, and universities.
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📌 Historical Context

- **Post-World War II Philippines:**
 - Struggling with nation-building.
 - Rising threat of communism and ideological battles.
 - Weakening sense of national identity.
 - Concerns about moral decline and corruption.
 - Nationalist leaders sought measures to **reawaken patriotism** and strengthen Filipino identity.
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📌 Key Figures

- **Sen. Claro M. Recto** – Main promoter of the Rizal Bill. Advocated Rizal’s works to instill nationalism and civic consciousness.
 - **Sen. Jose P. Laurel** – Chairman of Senate Committee on Education; sponsored Senate Bill No. 438.
 - **Cong. Jacobo Z. Gonzales** – Filed House Bill No. 5561 in the House of Representatives.
 - **President Ramon Magsaysay** – Signed the bill into law on **June 12, 1956**.
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📌 Important Bills & Dates

- **April 3, 1956:** Senate Bill No. 438 filed.
 - **April 17, 1956:** Laurel presented the bill to the Senate.
 - **April 19, 1956:** House Bill No. 5561 filed.
 - **April 23, 1956:** Senate debates began.
 - **May 17, 1956:** Senate and House versions approved.
 - **June 12, 1956:** President Magsaysay signed RA 1425 into law.
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📌 Provisions

- Compulsory reading of *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo* (original or approved English translations).
 - Inclusion of Rizal’s life and works in curricula.
 - Accessibility of Rizal’s works beyond schools, breaking socioeconomic and linguistic barriers.
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📌 Supporters’ Arguments

- Rizal’s novels reflect Filipino society — “like a mirror” (Laurel).
 - Promote **self-reliance, self-respect, and freedom**.
 - Encourage **national dignity, personal pride, and patriotism** (Recto).
 - Not anti-religion, but aimed at civic consciousness.
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📌 Opposition

- **Senators Mariano J. Cuenco, Francisco Rodrigo, Decoroso Rosales** – Devout Catholics opposing the bill.
- **Catholic Church:**
 - Archbishop **Rufino Santos** issued a pastoral letter.
 - Fr. **Jesus Cavanna** argued novels were outdated.
 - Claimed novels contained **anti-Catholic content** (170 lines in *Noli*, 50 lines in *El Fili*).

- Feared violation of religious freedom and division of the nation.

 Compromise

- Students with religious objections could be **exempted** from reading unexpurgated versions.

 Historical Significance

- Tested the Republic’s ability to uphold **secular governance**.
- Reflected the balance of power between **State and Church**.
- Cemented Rizal’s role as the **symbol of Filipino nationalism**.

2. Nationalism (Contextual Highlights)

 Definition

- **Nationalism:** A strong sense of loyalty and devotion to one’s nation, emphasizing unity, independence, and identity.
- **Nationalism** is the ideology and movement that emphasizes loyalty, devotion, and pride in one’s nation. It involves **unity, independence, and identity**, and often arises in response to foreign domination or colonial rule.
- In the Philippine context, nationalism meant **resisting colonial mentality**, asserting sovereignty, and cultivating pride in Filipino culture and history.

 Post-War Nation Building

- After WWII, the Philippines faced:
 - **Rising threat of communism.**
 - **Weakening national identity.**
 - **Moral decline and corruption concerns.**
- Rizal’s works were promoted as tools to **counter colonial mentality** and **reawaken Filipino identity**.

 Importance

- Cultivates **nationalism and patriotism**.
- Encourages **freedom, sacrifice, and moral growth**.
- Empowers the youth to stand up for their country.

3. Quick Recall Table

Date	Event	Key Figures
April 3, 1956	Senate Bill No. 438 filed	Sen. Claro M. Recto
April 17, 1956	Bill presented to Senate	Sen. Jose P. Laurel
April 19, 1956	House Bill No. 5561 filed	Cong. Jacobo Z. Gonzales
April 23, 1956	Senate debates began	Recto, Laurel, Opposing Senators
May 17, 1956	Senate & House approved	Both chambers
June 12, 1956	RA 1425 signed into law	Pres. Ramon Magsaysay

Lesson 3: Chinese Mestizos in Philippine Society

Definition

- **Chinese Mestizo:** A person of mixed Chinese and native Filipino ancestry.
- By the 19th century, they became a **prominent middle class**, influential in commerce, industry, and politics.

Key Dates

- **16th century:** Chinese presence in the archipelago.
- **1594:** Gov. **Luis Pérez Dasmariñas** created **Binondo** settlement for Catholic Chinese mestizos.
- **17th century:** Chinese-Filipino marriages in Iloilo, Pampanga, Cebu; mestizos in Pangasinan, Benguet, Mountain Province.
- **End of 19th century:** ~500,000 Chinese mestizos in Philippines (46,000 in Manila).

Social Classes

1. **Peninsular** – Spaniard born in Spain.
2. **Insular** – Spaniard born in the Philippines.
3. **Mestizo** – Mixed parentage (Spanish or Chinese + native).
4. **Principalia** – Wealthy pure-blooded natives.
5. **Indio** – Pure-blooded native Filipinos.
6. **Chino infiel** – Non-Catholic pure-blooded Chinese.

Significance

- Eviction of Chinese migrants → Chinese mestizos rose in industry, commerce, business.
- Monopolized internal trade; Spanish mestizos focused on foreign trade.
- Emerged as middle class — active, enterprising, trade-oriented.
- Shared grievances with Indios against Spanish abuses.
- Rekindled nationalist opposition to colonial abuses.

Key Figures

- **Pedro Paterno** and **Gregorio Sancianco** – Chinese mestizos who

wrote about Filipino dignity and identity in late 1870s.

- **José Rizal** – Descended from Chinese lineage; writings nurtured by earlier mestizo intellectuals.
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Lesson 4: Rizal's Childhood and Early Education

- Rizal's **early education** refers to his formative years of learning, beginning at home under his mother's guidance, continuing with private tutors, and later in formal schools such as Biñan and Ateneo.
- His education emphasized **reading, writing, arithmetic, religion, Spanish, Latin, arts, and moral values**, laying the foundation for his intellectual and moral development.

Expanded Family Influence

- **Doña Teodora Alonso (mother):** First teacher; taught him alphabet at age 3, prayers, and reading. Patient, conscientious, and understanding.
- **Father (Francisco Mercado):** Told moral stories (donkey "Alipato," dog "Usman").
- **Uncle Manuel Alberto:** Encouraged physical development and love for nature.
- **Uncle Gregorio:** Instilled value of education.

Expanded Tutors

- **Maestro Celestino** – First private tutor.
- **Maestro Lucas Padua** – Second tutor.
- **Leon Monroy** – Taught Spanish and Latin; died after 5 months.

Biñan Education

- Teacher: **Maestro Justiniano Aquino Cruz** – strict but formative.
- **Juancho** taught painting and drawing.
- Routine: mass, orchard, class at 10 AM, study until 5 PM, prayers before bed.
- Returned to Calamba on **Dec 17, 1870** via steamship *Talim*, accompanied by **Arturo Camps**.

Ateneo Municipal de Manila (1872–1877)

- Initially planned for Colegio de San Juan de Letran, but **Paciano** convinced family to send him to Ateneo.

- Admitted with help of **Manuel Xerez Burgos** (nephew of Father José Burgos).
- Registrar **Father Magin Ferrando** initially refused admission (late registration, sickly).
- Adopted surname "**Rizal**" instead of Mercado to avoid political suspicion.
- Classes divided into **interns (Roman Empire)** and **externs (Carthaginian Empire)**.
- Rose from bottom rank to **Emperor**.
- Won first prize: **religious picture**.
- Took extra Spanish lessons at **Santa Isabel College** (3 pesos).
- Became **interno** on **June 16, 1875**.

Influential Teacher

- **Fr. Francisco de Paula Sanchez, S.J.** – Rizal's best professor; inspired poetry and sculpture (*Sagrado Corazón de Jesús*).

Expanded Achievements

- Excelled in academics, arts, literature, and sciences.
- Wrote poems and crafted sculptures.
- Issued **surveyor's certificate** on **Nov 25, 1881** (age 20, underage to practice).
- His education prepared him for higher studies in Manila and abroad, shaping him into a national hero.

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1594	Binondo settlement	Gov. Luis Pérez Dasmariñas
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Dec 17, 1870	Rizal returned to Calamba	Arturo Camps
1872–1877	Ateneo education	Manuel Xerez Burgos, Fr. Sanchez
Nov 25, 1881	Surveyor certificate issued	Rizal